

Chapter 59-5

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The two people's Weibo posts were published simultaneously. One pretended to be magnanimous, the other was passive-aggressive and spoke with righteous indignation.

Bai Weiwei was willing to bear the infamy herself to shape Chen Liuying's online image well.

The deliberately crafted noble image for Chen Liuying was displayed vividly in this Weibo post. It looked very literary, but the underlying meaning was—you did hit someone, but I won't hold it against you. I hope you'll conduct yourself better in the future!

It must be said that in terms of public opinion rhetoric and understanding netizens' psychology, Bai Weiwei had grasped the essence.

She easily performed a feat of using four ounces to move a thousand pounds¹.

Now netizens loved Chen Liuying even more, and the speed of her follower growth was even faster than before.

At the same time, curses erupted online.

Before Xu Qingzhu spoke up, netizens had only been cursing Minghui Jewelry. Almost everyone was attacking Minghui Jewelry's official Weibo. But then Xu Qingzhu spoke up on Weibo.

Things immediately became lively. Everyone rushed to her Weibo to curse madly, especially Chen Liuying's fans, saying things like, "You're taking advantage of my sister's gentlemanly demeanor to hit people. You deserve to die."

The most vicious comments attacked Xu Qingzhu's entire family.

There were too many negative comments to read through all at once.

Sally, sitting in the office, looked at the private messages constantly popping up in the backend and exclaimed in shock: "They're really too vicious."

Liang Shi said: "Don't take it to heart. They're all just fence-sitters²."

"Are we still not going to strike now?" Lin Luoxi said: "At least release a lawyer's letter to show our stance and attitude. Netizens have already decided we're in the wrong."

"It's not time yet." Liang Shi glanced at the time: "Let the public opinion ferment a bit more."

Ten minutes after Bai Weiwei and Chen Liuying's Weibo posts went out, Liang Shi, controlling Xu Qingzhu's account, posted a second Weibo:

@Xu Qingzhu-Blanche: The video is certainly not fake, but why is there no audio track? Can my guilt be determined with just one image? Isn't this too arbitrary? There were only the three of us in the restroom that day. You recorded the video, so naturally you know what happened. So—why are you framing me? @Bai Weiwei.

And do you dare to step forward and openly say you have a clear conscience? Do you dare to tell everyone what really happened that day? @Chen Liuying.

Liang Shi's wording was rigorous and precise, giving people a sense of psychological oppression.

It also conveyed an attitude to the public—I didn't do it. You're framing me.

And the public would only say: If you have the ability, produce evidence. Don't just use words to manipulate people's emotions here.

But from Bai Weiwei's perspective, at this moment Xu Qingzhu was like a spent force³. She had no evidence, so she could do nothing but use pale words to threaten her, trying to gain the public's sympathy.

Bai Weiwei became even more unbridled and directly confronted her online.

@Bai Weiwei: As close friends, I naturally didn't want things to reach this point. You know better than I do what happened that day. Well-intentioned persuasion became malicious misinterpretation. Attempts to ease relations led us further apart due to your behavior. I wanted to say let's part amicably, but you won't let it go. Whether you're being wrongly accused or not, you know in your heart. People shouldn't forget others' human rights just because they have privilege.

Choosing to trend on a day like this, in this manner—is this what you wanted? I've always known some people would stop at nothing to achieve their goals, but I never imagined such methods would be used on me someday.

Chen Liuying's Weibo also posted:

@Chen Liuying: Let this matter pass. Stop wasting public resources.

In an instant, Xu Qingzhu became the villain who maliciously occupied public resources and would stop at nothing to achieve her goals.

It must be said that Bai Weiwei was masterful at implying things about others and throwing dirty water on them.

Everyone knew today was the day of Minghui Jewelry's autumn new product launch. On such a day, Xu Qingzhu's incident was exposed. Negative trending topics were still trending topics—that was still traffic!

Plus with Zhao Ying and Yang Shuyan's endorsements afterward, wasn't this exactly what Bai Weiwei meant by "stopping at nothing to achieve goals"?

Buy negative trending topics, then deliberately whitewash.

This was typical marketing, and it was marketing by stepping on Chen Liuying.

Good heavens.

In the fans' eyes, this was practically like dancing on Chen Liuying's grave!

So Chen Liuying's fans exploded!

Without caring about anything else, they went to attack Xu Qingzhu, cursing her to be worthless, wishing she'd be hit by a car that very day. They also cursed Zhao Ying and Yang Shuyan, saying they were taking dirty money and deserved to die.

These fans at this moment were a bunch of lunatics, cursing whoever they caught.

So online curses erupted in warfare, with several parties in chaotic battle.

Originally, Zhao Ying's and Yang Shuyan's fan groups were the two most antagonistic fan groups in the entertainment industry. But today, on this day that seemed like nothing special, they unexpectedly united and began surrounding Chen Liuying's fans.

As the saying goes, the enemy of my enemy is a friend.

So everyone witnessed the great unity of the entertainment industry that day.

In the countless days afterward, this incident became a strange tale of melon-eating⁴ for casual observers.

At its root, it was because Chen Liuying's fans were jumping too high and making too much noise.

Netizens weren't stupid either. Thinking it over, they realized Bai Weiwei had a point.

Who would want the entire internet to see themselves getting beaten for no reason?

Wouldn't that be indirectly saying they were useless?

And Chen Liuying had been maintaining a persona as "the internet's number one 御A⁵." This video had only been out for half a day, and people online were already making memes of Chen Liuying.

That GIF of her head hitting the wall was being used as an emoji, wildly parodied by netizens, and forwarded countless times.

It would probably become the biggest dark history since Chen Liuying's debut.

If it was to bring down Minghui Jewelry, the sacrifice for Chen Liuying seemed too great.

Moreover, there was no grudge between them.

Why would she go this far?

So now the person most likely to do this was Xu Qingzhu—that is, Minghui Jewelry.

Netizens who thought they understood the entire situation sorted out the overall logic of events and then said very "wisely": "This can be called a very successful self-hype event."

After all, all of Minghui Jewelry's goods had already become in a state of supply falling short of demand.

Anyone who saw it couldn't help but be convinced.

Even marketing major students sighed: "Which marketing expert is behind this company? This incident could be put in textbooks as a case study (if it doesn't end in failure)."

Netizens who had bought goods during the day also felt they'd been deceived and wanted to return their purchases.

But some people lived close to shopping malls and had already gotten the actual products from counters.

The real-life photos netizens posted showed that the viewing experience when worn was even better than the official website photos.

People who wanted returns really couldn't resist the temptation.

So while Minghui Jewelry's backend orders had some losses, they weren't severe.

And at this moment, as lights came on across the city, the entire city entered the slow pace of evening. In Minghui Jewelry's office, Liang Shi ordered crawfish and barbecue for everyone.

Everyone: "...???"

It must be said, crawfish and barbecue were still fragrant.

Even someone as aloof and noble as Zhou Yi'an, upon smelling the aroma, couldn't help but take gloves from the table and join everyone.

Footnotes:

¹ Using four ounces to move a thousand pounds: A Chinese idiom meaning to achieve great results with minimal effort.

² Fence-sitters: People who change their opinions easily based on circumstances; bandwagon followers.

³ Spent force: Translated from Chinese idiom meaning someone who has exhausted their strength or resources.

⁴ Melon-eating: Internet slang for watching drama unfold as a spectator; being entertained by others' conflicts.

⁵ 御A: A type of Alpha personality in ABO dynamics, specifically one who is commanding and dominant yet maintains composure and elegance.